

People Profiling for Ethical Sales & Discovery

A sourced working-profile handbook — hypotheses, not labels

Prepared for: Evan Symons

Audience: finance student · server · SDR / persuasion practice · CRM desks

Use cases: interview · gym lead desk · ILT / EDO partner-funded seats

As of: 8 September 2026 (America/Chicago)

Method: peer-reviewed reviews/meta-analyses + classics from the Brief

ETHICS BANNER

No physiognomy · no race/IQ · no microexpression-as-certainty · no covert surveillance.

Culture frameworks include critiques on the same pages. Thin slices have limits.

Profiles are drafts you revise. Never a license to stereotype, discriminate, or surveil.

When unsure, ask. When harmful, stop.

How to use this paper

You do not “read” people. You build a working profile: observe → infer lightly → TEST → revise. Hypotheses, not labels. Update when evidence arrives; discard when it fails.

Loop: Observe. Infer (one sentence). Test with a question or small next step. Revise. Ethics check. Repeat. CRM the evidence.

Reading map

- Part 1 — Observable vs inferred; thin-slice science with limits.
- Part 2 — Cultural intelligence as vocabulary, with critiques on the same pages.
- Part 3 — Big Five / HEXACO; MBTI caveat; motivational interviewing stance.
- Part 4 — Decision cues: say vs do; consistency limits; prestige vs dominance.
- Part 5 — Interview / gym / EDO discovery playbooks.
- Part 6 — Bias traps and named bans.
- Part 7 — Practice loop and drills.
- Part 8 — One-page cheat sheet.
- Sources — Numbered bibliography from the Brief only.

Hard rules (non-negotiable)

No physiognomy, race/IQ, microexpression-as-certainty, or covert surveillance tips. Culture frameworks include critiques. Thin-slice accuracy is limited (Ambady & Rosenthal $r \approx .39$; Hall midway; Murphy & Hall construct-dependent). Only numbers and claims present in the Brief.

Epistemic posture

Warm, sharp, revisable. Never “read people like a book.” Never teach covert ops. A first impression is a draft hypothesis about this interaction, not a biography.

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- Part 4 — Decision cues (say vs do; consistency; prestige vs dominance)
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- Part 6 — Bias & ethics (named bans)
- Part 7 — Practice loop + drills
- Part 8 — One-page cheat sheet + glossary
- Numbered sources (from Brief)

How this paper was built

Body phrasing follows the teaching outline (Explain). Every factual claim, effect size, and citation is limited to the research Brief. Diagram captions follow Explain. Visuals are schematic — no photos of real people.

Executive summary

Thin-slice research shows short excerpts of expressive behavior can predict some interpersonal outcomes above chance (Ambady & Rosenthal, 1992). Later work shows predictive validity depends on what is judged, how it is measured, and context — accuracy is typically midway between guessing and perfection (Hall et al., 2008; Murphy & Hall, 2021). That licenses careful noticing, not stereotyping.

Cultural frameworks (Hofstede, Hall high/low context, Trompenaars) are diagnostic vocabulary — dangerous as national personality stamps. Critiques are mandatory: ecological fallacy; nation ≠ person; WEIRD samples; essentialism (McSweeney, 2002; Brewer & Venaik, 2012, 2014; Henrich, Heine, & Norenzayan, 2010; Kittler, Rygl, & Mackinnon, 2011).

Trait personality (Big Five / HEXACO) is better grounded than type systems. Conscientiousness repeatedly predicts academic and job performance in meta-analyses; other traits are smaller and context-dependent (Poropat, 2009; Zell & Lesick, 2021; Soto, 2019). MBTI is popular and not predictive science unless carefully caveated (Pittenger, 1993, 2005). Motivational interviewing (Miller & Rollnick) offers a collaborative discovery stance with modest, setting-dependent effects (Lundahl et al., 2013; Frost et al., 2018).

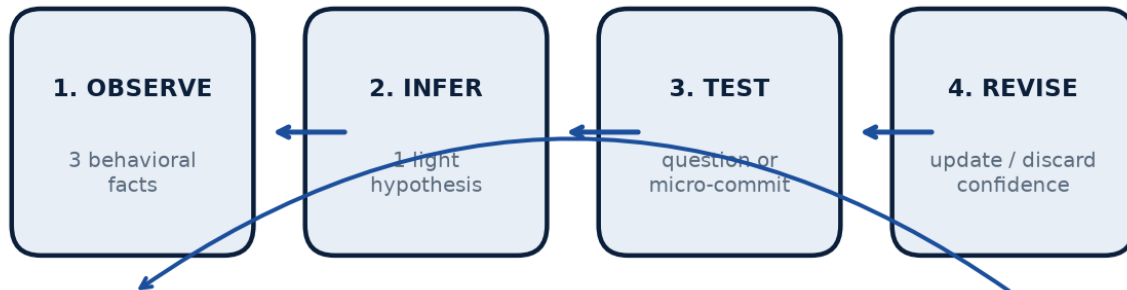
Decision cues beat vibes: say–do gaps, commitment/consistency with limits (Preference for Consistency), and behavioral prestige vs dominance signals (Cialdini; Beaman et al., 1983; Burger, 1999; Guadagno & Cialdini, 2010; Cheng, Tracy, et al., 2013).

Ethics is load-bearing. Confirmation bias, fundamental attribution error, stereotyping, and stop rules separate professional discovery from harm. Microexpression-as-lie-detection and physiognomy are banned (Barrett et al., 2019; Vrij et al.; APA Ethics Code, 2017).

For Evan's desks

Prepare interviews, gym lead conversations, and ILT/EDO partner-seat discovery as hypotheses you test in talk and follow-through — never covert ops or fixed labels.

Working-profile loop (Funder RAM-compatible noticing)



Ethics check each cycle · CRM the evidence · never 'certain'

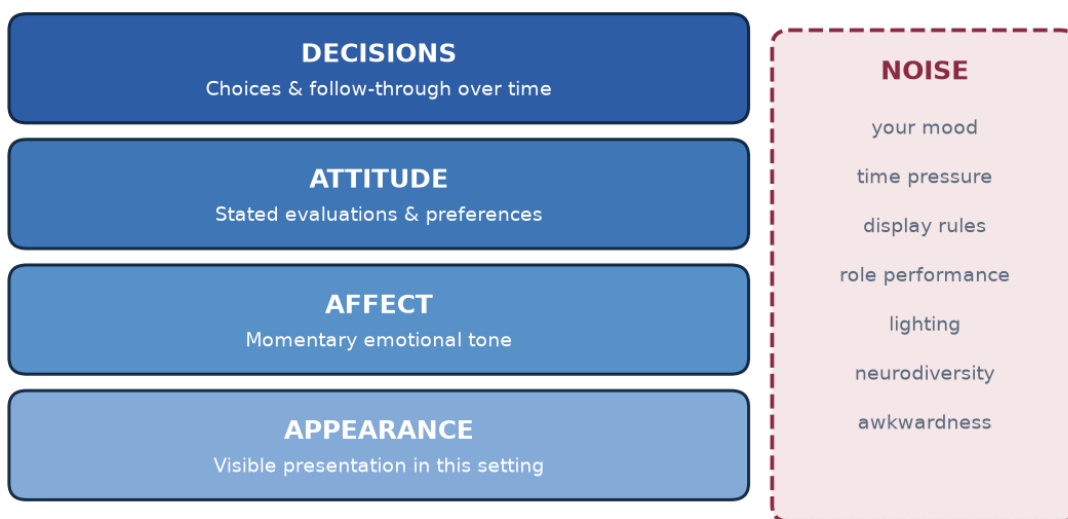
Figure 1. Observe → Infer → Test → Revise (+ ethics).

Observable vs inferred — and what is noise

Keep four layers separate. Collapsing them is how clothes become “character” and one flash of mood becomes a trait. Noise includes your mood, lighting, time pressure, first-meeting awkwardness, cultural display rules, neurodiversity, and role performance (interview self, sales self, gym self).

The four layers

Four layers — keep them separate (plus noise)



Collapsing layers → character from clothes / one flash as a trait [WEAK/POP]

Figure 2. Four layers (appearance / affect / attitude / decisions) plus a noise band.

Layer	What it is	Discovery example	Risk if collapsed
Appearance	Visible presentation in this setting	Partner wears company hoodie; gym lead arrives with headphones	Inferring character from clothes [WEAK/POP]
Affect	Momentary emotional tone	Prospect softens when topic shifts to team outcomes	Treating one flash as a trait
Attitude	Stated evaluations and preferences	“We only buy when ROI is clear in Q1”	Believing stated attitude = future behavior
Decisions	Choices and follow-through over time	Agrees to intro call; no-shows twice	Ignoring the say–do gap

Funder’s Realistic Accuracy Model (RAM) is the clean scientific frame: accurate judgment requires that trait-relevant behavior be relevant, available, detected, and utilized — four places error enters (Funder, 1995; Funder, 2012).

Thin slices: what the science actually says

Ambady and Rosenthal (1992) meta-analyzed studies using brief observations (<5 minutes, often far shorter) of expressive behavior. Mean effect size was about $r = .39$ for predicting interpersonal criteria — meaningfully

above chance, not certainty. Accuracy was not simply “longer is better” in that between-study design.

Thin slices: above chance, not certainty

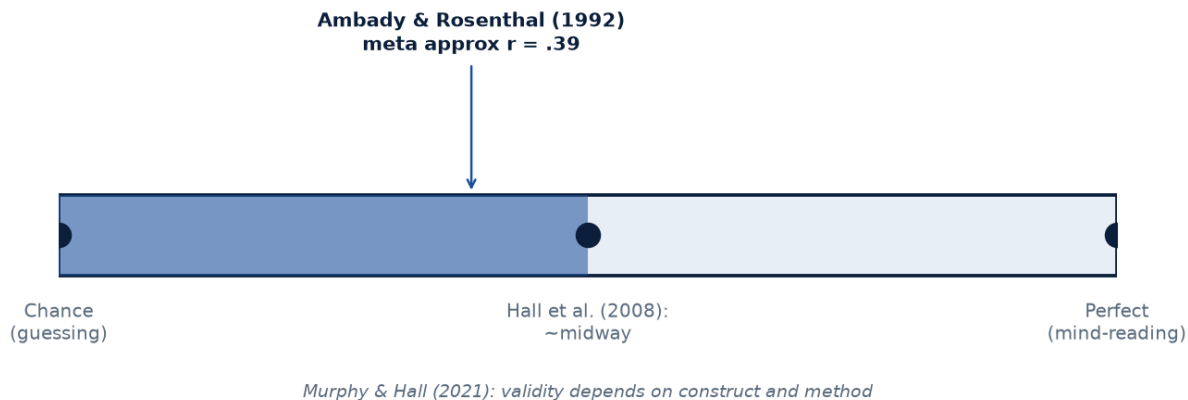


Figure 3. Thin slice chance–perfect middle (Hall et al., 2008; Ambady & Rosenthal $r \approx .39$).

- Hall et al. (2008): Across many interpersonal-accuracy tests, mean accuracy sits roughly midway between chance and perfect.
- Murphy & Hall (2021): Representativeness, predictive validity, and accuracy-length validity all depend on construct and method. Some behaviors travel better across slices than others. Slices from the very start can be weaker.
- Carney, Colvin, & Hall (2007): Some Big Five traits (extraversion, conscientiousness) gain with longer exposure; agreeableness can be harder early (agreeableness asymmetry also in Ames & Bianchi, 2008).
- Murphy et al. (2019); Wang et al. (2020): Predictive validity of short slices is often close to longer totals for many outcomes — with losses researchers must judge as “good enough” or not.

Teaching rule for Evan

A first impression is a draft hypothesis about this interaction, not a biography. Extraversion-like energy is relatively easy early; trustworthiness, agreeableness, and deep motives are not. [WEAK/POP] claims that “you decide in seven seconds and you’re usually right” oversell confidence.

Why accuracy fails (RAM in plain language)

Funder’s Realistic Accuracy Model is practical for desks: if the trait-relevant behavior never happens (not relevant), or happens where you cannot see it (not available), or you miss it (not detected), or you misread it (not utilized), the profile goes wrong. Most desk errors are utilization errors — jumping from one observable to a biography.

Murphy & Hall (2021) remind us that thin slices are a research and noticing tool, not a license to stereotype. Carney, Colvin, & Hall (2007) show some traits are easier early (extraversion-like energy) while agreeableness can be asymmetric and harder early (Ames & Bianchi, 2008). That is why confidence stays provisional.

What to observe (behavioral, not racial)

Observable vs inferred (discipline)

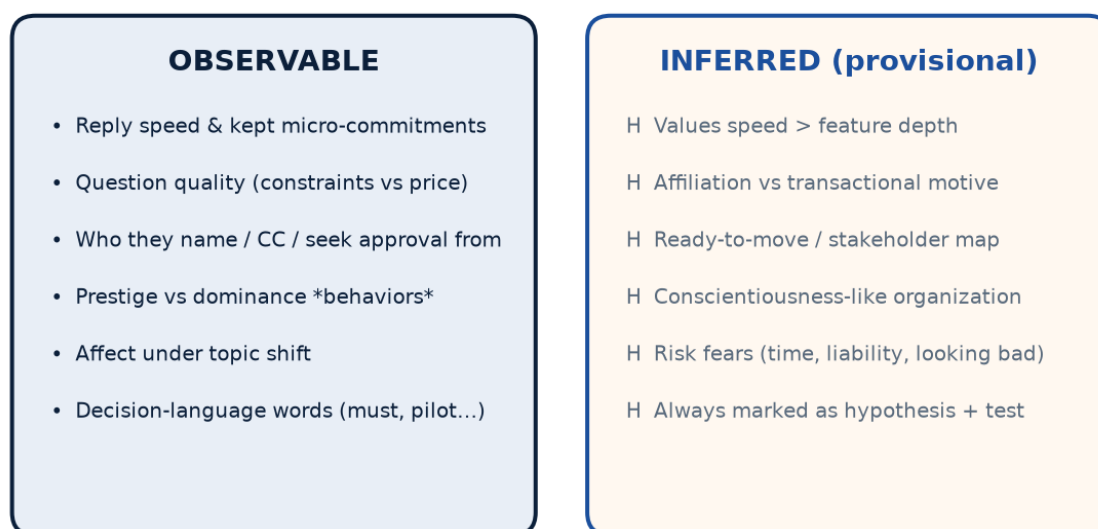


Figure 3b. Observable vs inferred — keep columns separate; inferences stay provisional.

- Time & follow-through: reply speed; kept micro-commitments.
- Question quality: constraints, stakeholders, metrics — or only price?
- Affiliation moves: who they name, CC, whose approval they seek.
- Status strategy (behavioral): prestige cues (teaching, sharing expertise) vs dominance cues (interrupting, space-taking, reduced affiliative smiling) — situational, not identity (Cheng et al., 2013; Witkower, Tracy, et al.).
- Affect under topic shift: what raises engagement vs shutdown (still a hypothesis).
- Language of decision: criteria words (“must,” “board,” “pilot,” “seasonality,” “liability”).

Banned observation targets

Do not use racial appearance, “ethnic looks,” skull/face structure, or physiognomy of any kind. Those are banned scientific and ethical failures.

Inference discipline

Write inferences as: “Hypothesis: values speed of implementation more than feature depth — because they asked about go-live twice and skipped the feature tour. Test: Ask what happened last time a vendor was slow; offer a 2-week pilot outline; watch whether they engage.” If the test fails, revise. If it succeeds once, keep confidence provisional.

Cultural intelligence — use lightly, never essentialize

Hofstede / Hall / Trompenaars = vocabulary. Use them to generate questions. Never as national personality stamps. Critiques live on these same pages — not in an appendix.

Three classic frameworks (vocabulary, not stamps)

Hofstede's dimensions

Individualism–collectivism, power distance, uncertainty avoidance, masculinity–femininity, long-term orientation, indulgence began as ecological analyses of IBM employee surveys aggregated to the nation level (Hofstede, 1980/2001; Hofstede Insights). Useful sales question: “In this org / this room, how much is hierarchy explicit? How much is risk language used?” Invalid: “They’re from Country X, so they are high power-distance people.”

Edward T. Hall — high vs low context

Beyond Culture (1976): high-context leans on shared background, indirectness, and relationship; low-context leans on explicit verbal content. Useful for noticing whether a prospect expects you to “get it” from relationship history vs needing a written one-pager. [OLDER] as anthropology; still widely taught.

Trompenaars & Hampden-Turner

Riding the Waves of Culture: dilemma-based dimensions (universalism–particularism, individualism–communitarianism, specific–diffuse, achievement–ascription). Designed for management dilemmas — contracts, teams, status. Useful prompt: “Is this a rules culture or a relationships culture in this deal?”

Nation is not person (ecological fallacy)

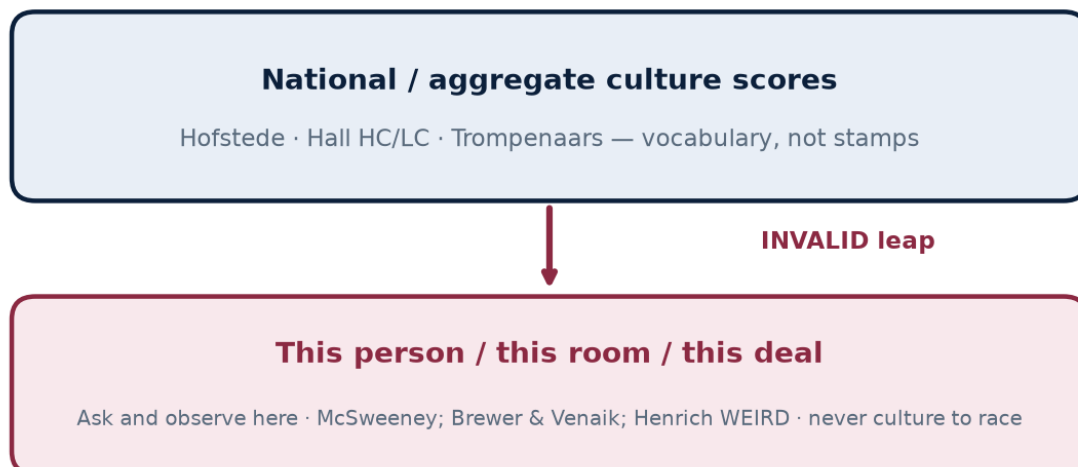


Figure 4. Nation ≠ person — ecological fallacy; ask and observe in this room.

Culture frameworks = questions, not stamps

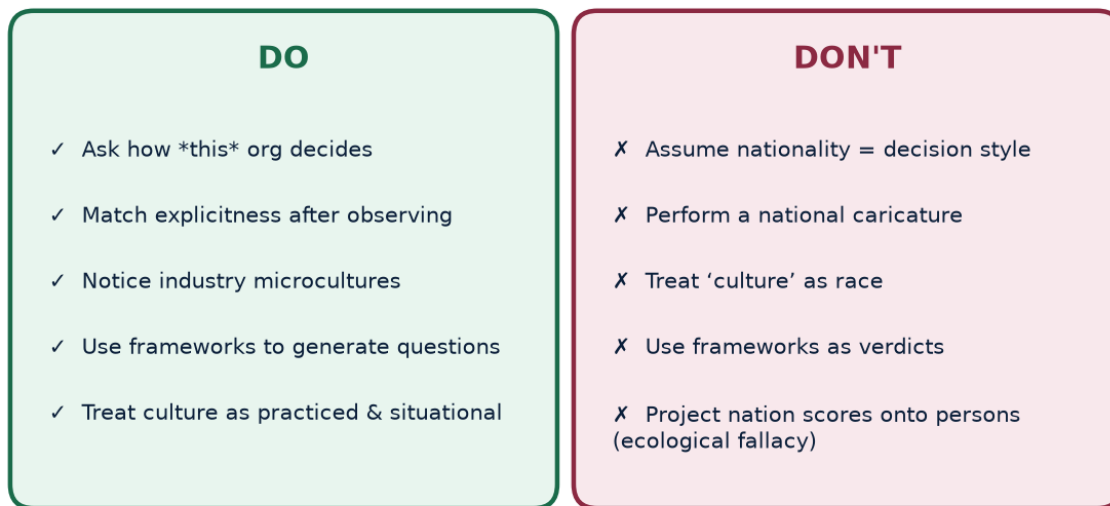


Figure 4b. Culture: use as questions, not stamps (do / don't).

Practitioner materials (e.g., Hofstede Insights) can help generate questions about hierarchy and risk language in a room. They do not authorize projecting a nation score onto a person. Multilevel meta-analytic work on Hofstede-related associations (Taras, Kirkman, & Steel, 2010) and large comparative projects such as GLOBE (House et al., 2004) belong in the same careful category: useful maps of aggregates, not stamps for individuals. Cardon (2008) also critiques simplistic applications of Hall's contexting model in business communication.

Major critiques (mandatory)

- Ecological fallacy / level of analysis: National dimension scores are not individual traits (Brewer & Venaik, 2012, 2014). Hofstede himself warned against treating dimensions as individual psychometrics.
- McSweeney (2002): IBM sample ≠ nation; nations are not homogeneous cultures; questionnaire differences are not automatically "national culture." Classic title: "A triumph of faith — a failure of analysis."
- Hall HC/LC country lists: Kittler, Rygl, & Mackinnon (2011) — many country classifications rest on less-than-adequate evidence; mixed/contradictory findings.
- WEIRD psychology: Henrich, Heine, & Norenzayan (2010) — Western, Educated, Industrialized, Rich, Democratic samples are often outliers. Midwestern U.S. campus/gym/partner intuition will overfit.
- Essentialism risk: Treating culture as fixed essence produces stereotyping and microaggressions (APA Multicultural Guidelines, 2017). Culture is practiced, situational, and intersectional.

Evan scenario (optional pattern, not an invented client story)

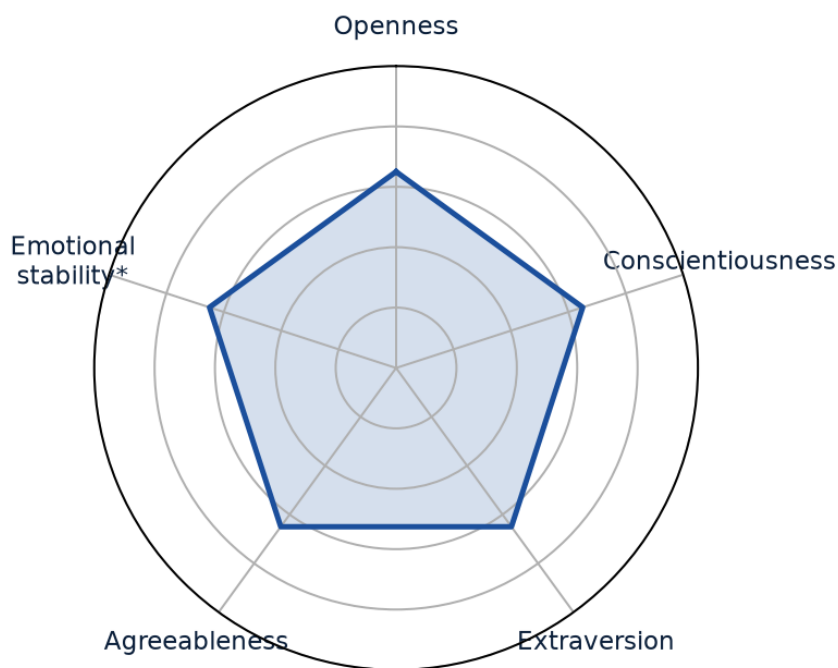
In an ILT partner / EDO-funded seat motion, a district partner's communication may look "high context" (relationship first, soft nos) or "low context" (send the ROI table). That is an org and person pattern to test — not a state or ethnicity rule.

Personality & attitude frameworks that are researched

Big Five (OCEAN) — high level

Openness, Conscientiousness, Extraversion, Agreeableness, Neuroticism (emotional stability reversed) — the dominant trait taxonomy in contemporary personality science (John & Srivastava tradition; McCrae & Costa FFM).

Big Five (OCEAN) — high-level labels only *Neuroticism pole; use as hypothesis language, not boxes



Meta-analyses: Conscientiousness strongest for performance (Poropat; Zell & Lesick) — still not destiny

Figure 5a. Big Five map — high-level labels only; hypothesis language, not boxes.

- Poropat (2009), Psychological Bulletin: Conscientiousness robustly relates to academic performance; often incremental to intelligence.
- Mammadov (2021/2022) meta-analysis: Conscientiousness remains strong; cognitive ability still primary for academic prediction; personality adds.
- Zell & Lesick (2021/2022): Quantitative synthesis of 50+ meta-analyses — Conscientiousness shows the strongest link to aggregate performance (~ medium vs small for other traits).
- Soto (2019) and mega-analytic robustness work: Traits remain associated with life outcomes with important covariate caveats.

Sales/discovery use: trait language is for hypotheses about how someone works, not boxes. High-C hypotheses → checklists, deadlines, written next steps. High-E → verbal brainstorming, peer social proof. High-A → relationship and harmony language — but early thin-slice agreeableness is easy to misread.

HEXACO — Honesty-Humility add-on

Ashton & Lee’s HEXACO adds Honesty–Humility (sincerity, fairness, greed avoidance, modesty) (Ashton & Lee, 2007; Ashton & Lee, 2020). Ethically useful: noticing sincerity/fairness behaviors over time beats “I can tell who’s honest from a handshake” [WEAK/POP].

Big Five / HEXACO vs MBTI

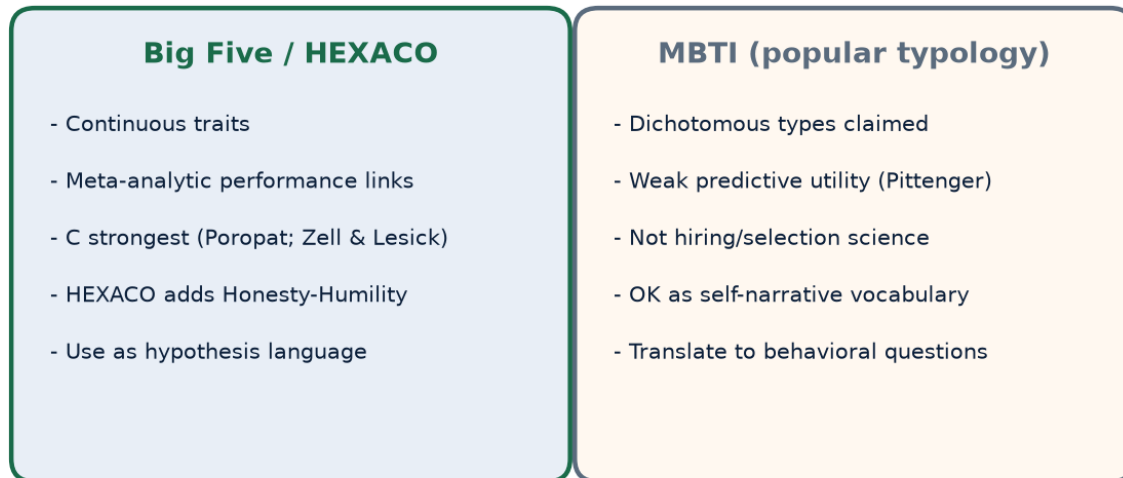


Figure 5. Big Five / HEXACO vs MBTI (Pittenger caveats).

MBTI — popular, not predictive science (caveated)

Scientific reviews find insufficient evidence for key claims: dichotomous types (vs continuous traits), strong predictive utility, and stable 4-letter destiny (Pittenger, 1993, 2005). Boyle (1995) notes psychometric limits. Frame for Evan: if a partner mentions their “type,” treat it as self-narrative and vocabulary they like — then translate to behavioral questions. Do not select partners, hire, or discriminate by MBTI.

Motivational interviewing & discovery questions

Miller & Rollnick’s Motivational Interviewing (MI) is a collaborative, goal-oriented communication style that explores ambivalence and strengthens the person’s own reasons for change (Miller & Rollnick, 2013, 3rd ed.). Core spirit: partnership, acceptance, compassion, evocation — not interrogation.

- Lundahl et al. (2013): MI in medical settings — modest overall advantage vs controls (OR ~1.55), heterogeneous.
- Frost et al. (2018), PLOS ONE review of reviews: mostly low/very-low GRADE evidence; some moderate-quality support for short-term benefits on selected behaviors.
- Cochrane-style and addiction reviews: small effects vs no intervention, mixed vs other active treatments — fidelity matters.

Transfer to sales discovery (ethical) — use MI stance, not clinical therapy cosplay:

- Open questions > stacked leading questions
- Reflective listening before pitching
- Summaries that check understanding
- Affirm autonomy (“You’re the one who decides if a pilot makes sense”)
- Elicit their change talk (“What would make this worth it in your world?”)

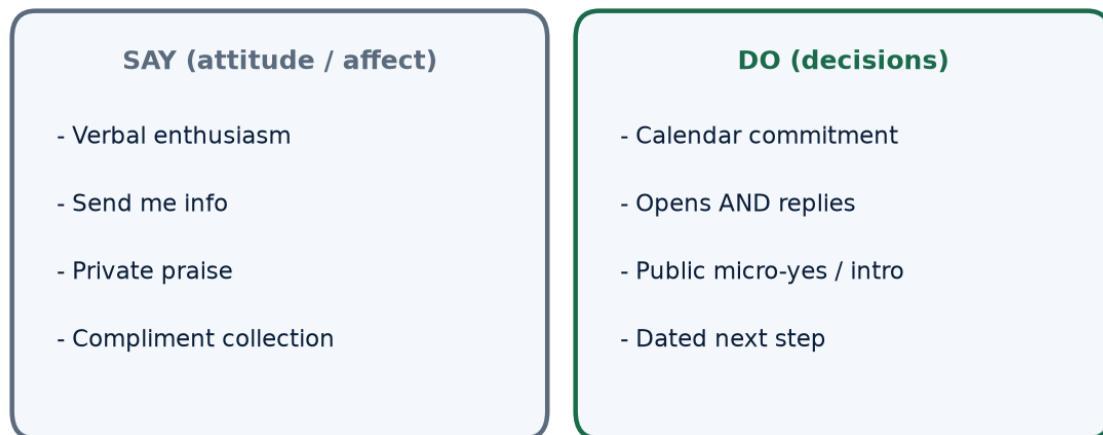
This aligns with CRM desk discipline: log their criteria, not your assumptions.

Decision cues: say vs do; consistency; status/affiliation

Say vs do

Classic attitude–behavior research shows attitudes predict behavior better when measures are specific, intentions are strong, and situational constraints are low (Fishbein & Ajzen reasoned-action / planned-behavior tradition — treat as [OLDER] core with modern TPB updates). In field sales:

Say vs do — prefer behavioral next steps



Fishbein-Ajzen tradition [OLDER core] · track say-do gaps in CRM

Figure 7. Say vs Do — prefer behavioral next steps with dates over compliment collection.

- Verbal enthusiasm ≠ calendar commitment
- “Send me info” ≠ engagement (track opens and replies)
- Public micro-yes (introducing you to a peer) is a stronger signal than private praise

Practice: Prefer behavioral next steps with dates over compliment collection.

Commitment & consistency (Cialdini — cite carefully)

Cialdini’s Influence synthesizes reciprocity, commitment/consistency, social proof, liking, authority, scarcity, and later unity (Pre-Suasion; expanded Influence). These are documented social-psychological tendencies, not guaranteed tactics and not a covert curriculum.

Limits you must teach yourself

- Foot-in-the-door meta-analyses find a real but often weak effect; many studies null or reversed (Beaman et al., 1983; Burger, 1999).
- Preference for Consistency (PFC) moderates consistency effects — not everyone is equally consistency-driven (Cialdini, Trost, & Newsom, 1995; Guadagno & Cialdini, 2010).
- Escalation of commitment literature (Staw tradition; Sleesman et al., 2012 meta-analysis) shows people sometimes throw good resources after bad — relevant to your sunk-cost bias as a seller, too.

Ethical vs unethical use

Ethical: help people make clear, voluntary, informed small commitments that match their goals. Unethical (forbidden here): trap people with manipulative escalating asks, deception, or isolation.

Behavioral status & affiliation signals (not racial)

Prestige vs dominance — behavior words only (Cheng, Tracy, et al.)

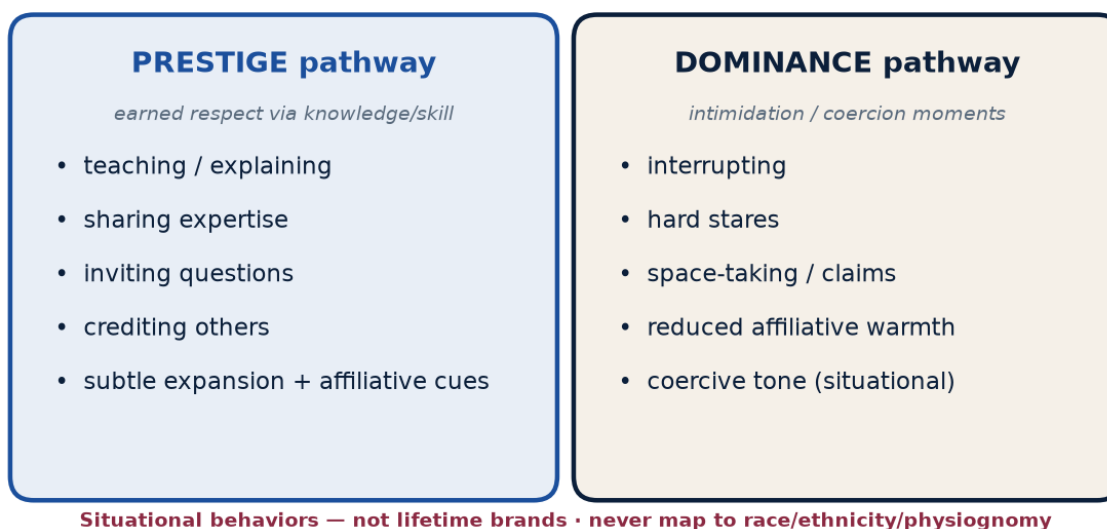


Figure 6. Prestige vs dominance — behavior words only (Cheng, Tracy, et al.).

Cheng, Tracy, Foulsham, Kingstone, & Henrich (2013): dominance (intimidation/coercion pathway) and prestige (earned respect via knowledge/skill) are distinct routes to rank. Later work maps distinct nonverbal displays (Witkower & Tracy line). Maner (2017) reviews hierarchy strategies.

- Prestige-oriented partners often teach, invite questions, credit others, expand subtly.
- Dominance-oriented moments look like interruptions, hard stares, space claims, low affiliative warmth — still situational, not a lifetime brand.
- Affiliation signals: inclusive pronouns, naming mutual contacts, seeking harmony, checking others' comfort.

Never map status reading to identity

Never map these to race, ethnicity, or physiognomy. Never use “status reading” to justify discrimination.

Dual-process reminder

People often decide with fast heuristics under load (Kahneman, 2011 popular synthesis of Kahneman–Tversky; Tversky & Kahneman, 1974). Your job in ethical discovery is sometimes to slow the room down so criteria become explicit — especially for partner-funded seats and interviews where regret is costly.

Affiliation motive (brief note)

Baumeister & Leary (1995) review the need to belong as a fundamental human motivation. In discovery rooms this shows up as inclusive pronouns, naming mutual contacts, seeking harmony, and checking others' comfort — affiliation signals listed alongside prestige/dominance behaviors. Treat belonging language as a hypothesis about

motive in context, not a personality stamp.

Observer accuracy research also reminds us that other-ratings can be informative when behavior is available to observers (Connelly & Ones, 2010). That supports logging observable behavior — not mind-reading.

Sales discovery playbooks — interview / gym / EDO

Build a working profile, then test it. Profiles without notes decay into vibes.

Working-profile template (one card)

Working-profile card (blank template)

SALES / INTERVIEW / GYM / EDO DISCOVERY

1. Context (role / org / constraints today): _____
2. Stated goals (their words): _____
3. Decision-process hypothesis (who / proof / timeline): _____
4. Motivation hypothesis (prestige / problem / affiliation / compliance / curiosity):

5. Risk language (time waste / looking bad / liability / money): _____
6. Evidence so far (2–4 observables): _____
7. Next test (one question or micro-commitment): _____
8. Confidence: ☐ Low ☐ Medium ☐ Never ‘certain’

Hypothesis → Test → Revise · Log in CRM · Educational use only

Sales discovery profile card template (blank fields).

- Context: Role, org, constraints visible today
- Stated goals: In their words
- Decision process hypothesis: Who else; what proof; what timeline
- Motivation hypothesis: Prestige / problem-removal / affiliation / compliance / curiosity
- Risk language: What they fear (time waste, looking bad, liability, money)
- Evidence so far: 2–4 observables
- Next test: One question or micro-commitment
- Confidence: Low / medium — never “certain”

A. Interview (finance / ops / sales-adjacent)

- Observe: How they structure answers (STAR vs vignette); whether they claim credit or distribute it; follow-up questions about your process.
- Infer lightly: Conscientiousness-like organization; affiliation to team vs self.
- Test: Ask for a concrete example with metrics; ask what they would need from you in week one.
- Revise: If stories stay abstract after two asks, lower confidence in a “results-driven” claim.

B. Gym lead desk

- Observe: Schedule fit, coaching style, friends who train, or only price? Energy on goals vs objections.
- Infer lightly: Affiliation motive vs pure transactional.
- Test: Offer a low-friction trial step they choose; watch follow-through.
- Revise: No-show after enthusiasm → weight say–do over affect. Do not shame; update profile and offer a different path or stop.

C. ILT / EDO partner-funded seat motions

- Observe: Student outcomes, funding mechanics, seat utilization, or personal relationship? Who must sign? What “success” means in their reporting world.
- Infer lightly: Institutional decision criteria; prestige vs dominance meeting style.
- Test: Send a one-page ROI/utilization sketch they can edit; schedule a second call with the named stakeholder.
- Revise: If they will not name a stakeholder after clear asks, your “ready to move” hypothesis is weak.

Discovery question families (MI-flavored, not coercion scripts)

- Goals: “What would better look like by [timeframe]?”
- Status quo: “What’s working well enough that you might not change?”
- Ambivalence: “What are the upsides of waiting?”
- Stakeholders: “Who else will care about this decision?”
- Evidence: “What would you need to see to trust a pilot?”
- Past: “Last time you tried something like this, what broke?”

Log answers in the CRM.

Inference write-up format (reuse everywhere)

Keep the same sentence shape across interview, gym, and EDO desks so notes stay comparable:

Template sentence

Hypothesis: [motive or criterion] — because [2 observables]. Test: [one question or micro-commitment].
Confidence: low/medium. Disconfirm if: [what would falsify].

Example (not an invented client story — a pattern): “Hypothesis: values speed of implementation more than feature depth — because they asked about go-live twice and skipped the feature tour. Test: ask what happened last time a vendor was slow; offer a 2-week pilot outline; watch engagement.”

Bias & ethics (mandatory, strong)

Bias traps then STOP rules



Figure 8. Bias traps → STOP (confirmation, FAE, stereotyping).

Confirmation bias

Nickerson (1998): seeking or interpreting evidence partial to existing beliefs. In profiling: you decided “they’re flaky,” then notice only the late reply and ignore the thoughtful email. Antidote: Write a disconfirming test every time you write a hypothesis.

Fundamental attribution error

Ross (1977) and the attribution tradition: over-attributing others’ behavior to disposition while under-weighting situation. Prospect was short → “rude person” vs “between meetings / culturally direct / nervous.” Antidote: Generate at least one situational explanation before a trait label.

Stereotyping & discrimination

APA Ethical Principles (2017) prohibit unfair discrimination and require respect for rights and dignity. APA Multicultural Guidelines (2017) warn against overgeneralization and stereotypic thinking. For Evan’s desks: never use protected-class stereotypes to decide outreach, pricing, seat offers, or “fit.” Behavioral org signals ≠ racial signals.

When to stop

- The person asks you to stop / shows clear discomfort
- You are gathering data they did not consent to share in that context
- You are tempted to use private social media stalking, keylogging, or covert recording — banned
- Your “profile” is becoming a fixed identity story that resists counterevidence
- The commercial relationship is not worth the ethical risk

Banned certainty systems

Claim	Status in this paper
Physiognomy / face structure → character	Banned — pseudoscience
Race / ethnicity → IQ or sales worth	Banned — discriminatory & false as practice rule
“Always trust first impressions”	[WEAK/POP] — overconfident
Microexpressions → reliable lie detection	Not supported as certainty tool
MBTI as hiring truth	Not predictive science

Ekman, microexpressions, and the emotion–face debate (careful)

Paul Ekman’s program advanced basic-emotion facial configurations and popularized microexpressions in deception contexts. Historically influential. Critiques and limits matter more for practice:

- Barrett, Adolphs, Marsella, Martinez, & Pollak (2019), PSPI: major challenge to inferring emotion from facial movements with the certainty many consumers assume; facial movements are variable and context-dependent.
- Gendron, Crivelli, & Barrett (2018): universality claims weaken under less constrained tasks and broader cultural samples.
- Porter & ten Brinke (2008) and later reviews: microexpressions are rare; do not cleanly separate liars and truth-tellers.
- Jordan et al. (2019) METT training study: microexpression training tool did not improve lie detection vs controls; accuracy ~chance.
- Vrij, Meissner, et al. (2017): nonverbal lie-detection tools including microexpression approaches lack adequate evidence.

Teaching line

Faces carry information. Faces are not a lie detector. Do not build a sales method on microexpression certainty.

Need for closure — seizing and freezing

Kruglanski & Webster (1996) describe motivated closing of the mind — “seizing” and “freezing” on judgments. In profiling, freezing looks like marrying a label after one call. Lord, Ross, & Lepper (1979) show biased assimilation: the same mixed evidence can polarize prior beliefs. Antidote: scheduled disconfirm tests and bias autopsies (Part 7).

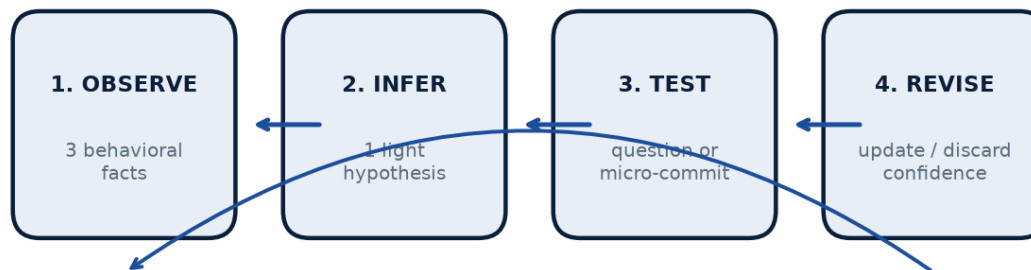
Positive ethics for discovery

- Informed, voluntary conversation
- Accurate logging (don’t invent CRM facts)
- Beneficence: help people make decisions that fit their constraints
- Humility: your profile is a draft
- Transparency appropriate to role (you are selling / interviewing — don’t pretend to be their therapist)

Practice loop + drills

The loop (daily)

Working-profile loop (Funder RAM-compatible noticing)



Ethics check each cycle · CRM the evidence · never ‘certain’

Daily loop reminder: observe → infer → test → revise (+ ethics).

- Observe 3 behavioral facts (write them).
- Infer 1 hypothesis in one sentence.
- Test with one question or micro-commitment.
- Revise confidence up/down; note disconfirming evidence.
- Ethics check: Did I stereotype? Am I stalking? Should I stop?

Eight drills

Drill 1 — Two-column notes (interview or call)

Left: quotes/behaviors. Right: inferences labeled H1, H2. Ban mixing columns.

Drill 2 — Disconfirm-on-purpose

State H1. Spend the next 5 minutes trying to falsify it. Log what you found.

Drill 3 — Say-do tracker (gym or partner follow-ups)

For one week, score verbal enthusiasm (1–5) vs completed next step (Y/N). Discuss the correlation honestly — usually imperfect.

Drill 4 — Stakeholder map (EDO/ILT seat motion)

From talk only, sketch who influences. Then ask: “Who else needs to be comfortable for this to move?” Update map.

Drill 5 — Prestige vs dominance spotting (behavioral only)

After a meeting, mark two moments of prestige-like behavior and two of dominance-like behavior. No demographic attributions.

Drill 6 — MI reflection reps

Partner with a friend: they speak 60 seconds about a real ambivalence. You only reflect and ask open questions — no advice for 3 minutes.

Drill 7 — Cultural light-touch

Pick Hall's high/low context as a question generator for one org. Write three questions that test explicitness needs. Do not assign a nationality score.

Drill 8 — Bias autopsy

Once a week, pick a wrong call you made about a person. Name confirmation bias, FAE, or stereotyping if present. Write the revised rule.

Suggested weekly cadence for Evan

Mon–Fri: run the daily loop on at least one real conversation (interview practice, gym desk, or partner call).
Wed: Drill 3 say–do tracker check. Fri: Drill 8 bias autopsy on one wrong call. Before any ILT/EDO seat motion: Drill 4 stakeholder map from talk only, then one clarifying ask.

One-page cheat sheet

1. Profiles are hypotheses you revise — never labels you marry.
2. Thin slices help a bit (Ambady & Rosenthal; Hall; Murphy & Hall) — accuracy is limited; not a stereotype license.
3. Separate appearance / affect / attitude / decisions.
4. Culture frameworks = vocabulary, not national personality (McSweeney; Brewer & Venaik; WEIRD).
5. Big Five/HEXACO > MBTI for science; MI stance > interrogation for discovery.
6. Watch say–do, voluntary commitments, and prestige/dominance behaviors.
7. Cialdini principles are real social psychology with weak-to-moderate, conditional effects — not spells.
8. Ethics first: no covert surveillance, no physiognomy, no race/IQ, no microexpression certainty, no discrimination.
9. CRM the evidence, not the vibe.
10. When unsure, ask; when harmful, stop.

One line

Testable profiles; revise with evidence; never covert ops; never stereotype.

Banned list (restate)

Do not build methods on these

Physiognomy · race/IQ · always-trust-first-impression · microexpressions-as-lie-detection ·
MBTI-as-hiring-truth · covert surveillance / stalking / keylogging / secret recording · culture-as-race ·
nation-score-as-person.

Glossary (compact)

Working profile. Provisional, testable model of a person's motives/decision pattern in context.

Thin slice. Short excerpt of behavior used for judgment or coding (typically <5 minutes in the Ambady tradition).

RAM. Funder's relevance–availability–detection–utilization path to accurate personality judgment.

Ecological fallacy. Inferring individual traits from aggregate (e.g., national) scores.

WEIRD. Western, Educated, Industrialized, Rich, Democratic — sample bias warning.

High/low context. Hall's continuum of how much meaning sits in shared context vs explicit words.

Big Five / HEXACO. Major trait models; HEXACO adds Honesty–Humility.

MBTI. Popular type inventory; weak as predictive science for most applied claims.

MI. Collaborative conversation style to elicit person's own motivation for change.

PFC. Preference for Consistency — individual difference moderating consistency effects.

Dominance vs prestige. Two behavioral pathways to social rank (intimidation vs earned respect).

Confirmation bias. Favoring evidence that fits prior belief.

FAE. Over-weighting disposition vs situation for others' behavior.

Microexpression. Very brief facial movement; not validated as reliable lie detection for practice.

Say-do gap. Divergence between stated intention and behavior.

Discovery. Structured learning about needs, constraints, and decision process — not covert extraction.

Numbered sources (from Brief)

Compact bibliography. Every material claim in this paper traces to these entries. No invented DOIs.

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Closing note. Profiles are drafts. Thin slices are limited. Culture is vocabulary with critiques. Ethics is the load-bearing wall. Prepared 8 September 2026 (America/Chicago) for Evan Symons — educational use.